Jonathan (the first year student)

Jonathan is an eighteen-year-old university student who just recently graduated from high school. He is majoring in mathematics, as it was his strongest subject in high school. He lives with his parents and his little sister, and he plans to work very hard in university so he can make his family proud. Jonathan is fairly anti-social and reserved, yet is able to maintain strong relationships once he gets to know other people well.

One of the main motivating factors that helped Jonathan maintain strong grades in high school was his friends. He regularly hung out with them, and would frequently study common subjects in a group with them. However, now that he lives on a university campus a few hours away from home, and most of his high school friends have moved away, this is difficult. Jonathan is a couple weeks into his first semester, and has struggled to make any friends within any of his core math classes.

Jonathan already feels that he is losing school motivation, as self-studying is not his most efficient method of learning. Although he has made a couple university friends through frosh week, they are in very different programs, meaning that he finds it difficult to effectively study with them. He wishes that he could find a group of individuals to connect and study with in the first year classes he is taking; however, he also feels intimidated by the large number of people, and often struggles with approaching other students for assistance.

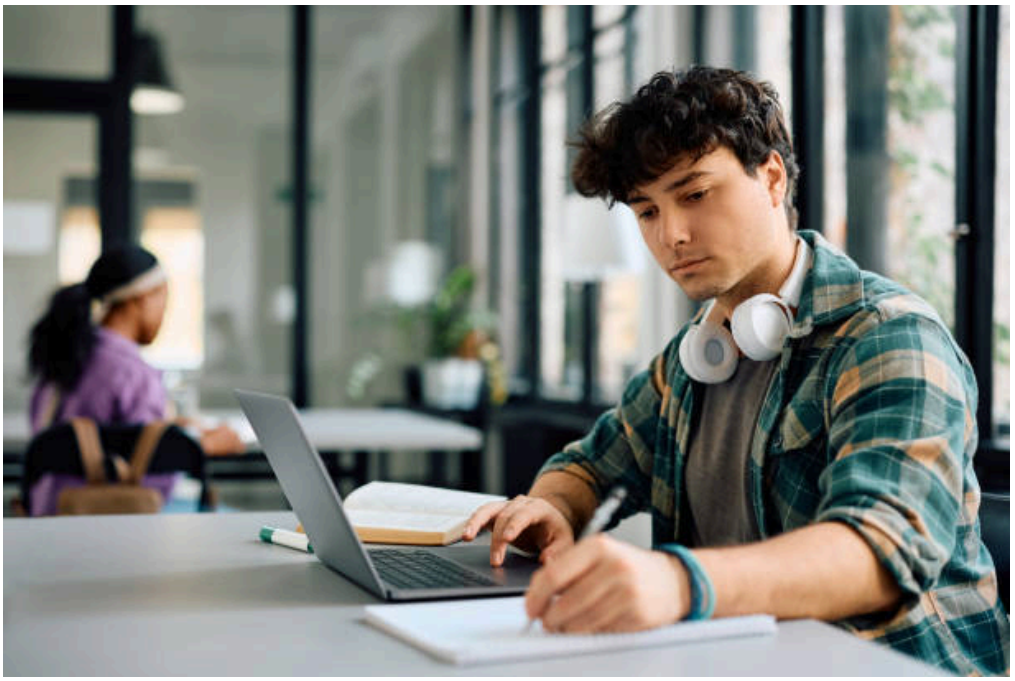
Alena (the commuter student)

Alena is a twenty-year-old, second year university student. She lives at home with her parents, which assist in funding her education. She is studying computer science, and currently works a part-time job at a Winners near her house. She feels that she owes a lot to her parents, so she picks up as many shifts as possible at work so she can at least pay for groceries, gas, and parking fees to the best of her ability.

Alena's home is a two and a half hour driving distance from university campus, and every day she has to leave her house at 7am to drive, find parking, and get to class on time. This semester, she has a five-course course load consisting mainly of core computer science courses. For her, these classes have been very difficult, as the concepts are getting very complex for her to grasp. She had a study group she could consistently study with in her first year, however everyone's schedules no longer align. She only has a couple of free hours on campus, and only on select days, mainly due to the large amount of time she must spend commuting back and forth between school, work, and home.

Alena feels like she had a lot more free time to hang out with her friends and her boyfriend in first year, which, in addition to her many hours spent commuting a day, is highly contributing to her stress. She feels like her time-management is getting worse, and that she is struggling to efficiently use the free time she has on campus. She thinks it would be very beneficial if she could find a group of people studying the same concepts that would also be free during the tight time frame when she is also available. This way, she could leverage off of the assistance of other students, and still be able to maintain good grades while staying social and working a job.

Tristan (the upper-year student)



Tristan is a twenty-two-year-old, fourth-year university student majoring in physics. He lived at home with his dad and his twin sister, Katie, but has lived on campus ever since starting university. Katie also attends the same university, however she is studying music, and thus has a very different skill set from himself. Tristan has managed to maintain a fairly average GPA throughout his university career, and wants to do a masters degree after graduation. For this reason, he wants to continue to maintain, and possibly even raise his GPA.

Tristan tends to prefer learning on his own, and has managed to self-teach most of the complicated physics courses he has had to take thus far. However, he barely passed a couple of these difficult classes in his third-year, and has realized that he may need to start reframing how he tackles complex topics in school. He had previously gotten tutoring when he was in high school, and it seemed to help him back then; so, he decided to look online for a tutor that would assist him. The additional help seemed to make a difference, however, now that he is further into his courses, and content is becoming extremely advanced and focused, it is much more difficult to find a qualified tutor.

Lately, Tristan has been assigned a large physics assignment, worth 20% of his total grade. The basis of this assignment revolves around the course slides, as the professor teaches the content in a very specific way. Thus, finding information about the content online is often ineffective. For this reason, Tristan desires to search for a way that he can organize and collaborate with his classmates. He believes that if he could start a study group, organize availability, and prompt his classmates to join, he and others would do very well in the course.